How Clear Is Your Family's Picture of How Dad's Care Would Be Paid For?

Thirteen quick questions about what you know and what you have in hand. At the end: what you know, what's still unclear, and what to ask.

Answer yes, no or not sure. This checks how complete your picture is. It doesn't measure Dad's finances, and nothing here says whether he could afford care or would qualify for anything.

1. Do you know what comes in for Dad each month, source by source?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

2. Do you know which savings, investments and property Dad has, by name? You don't need balances.

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

3. Do you know which retirement accounts or pensions he has, and which company is behind each?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

4. Do you know whether Dad has a long-term care insurance policy?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

5. For each insurance policy or annuity he has, has someone in the family seen the paperwork, as opposed to hearing about it?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

6. Do you know what health coverage Dad has now, from his cards and plan papers?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

7. Do you know whether Dad has ever looked into veterans or other benefits?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

8. Have you heard from Dad, in his own words, what would matter most to him if he ever needed care, including where he'd want to live?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

9. Have you written down the things you've heard about paying for care or about Medicaid, with where each one came from?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

10. Have you written down your questions about what care could cost and how long Dad's resources might last, for a professional to answer?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

11. Have you written down your questions about how Dad's assets may be treated and which strategies to raise with a professional?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

12. For each open question, do you know who you'd take it to?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

13. Is what you know on one dated page, and have you agreed when you'd look at it again?

◯ Yes ◯ No ◯ Not sure

Answer the questions above and your page builds here.

WHAT YOU KNOW

WHAT'S STILL UNCLEAR

QUESTIONS TO CLARIFY

What this doesn't do

It counts what you know, not what Dad has, whether it would be enough, or whether he would qualify for anything. A low count means there are things to find out, and most of them are a conversation with Dad or a look through the filing cabinet away. What any of it means for paying for care is a question for your Medicaid planner or the appropriate licensed professional. Nothing here is legal, financial, tax or insurance advice.

Ready for the next step?

You can see which parts of the picture you know, which you're guessing at, and what to ask. The planning interview asks about your family's situation and gives you a free planning report you can bring to any conversation about paying for care. Keep the page you just copied beside you while you answer.

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